

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

POETRY CHAPTER 7: MACAVITY: THE MYSTERY CAT (BY T.S. ELIOT)

 CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"Macavity: The Mystery Cat" is a humorous and satirical poem by T.S. Eliot. It describes a highly cunning, elusive ginger cat who commits crimes and breaks all human laws, including the law of gravity. Dubbed the "Napoleon of Crime," Macavity constantly evades the police, leaving absolutely no clues behind.

 12 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. Why is Macavity called a "Mystery Cat"?

Ans: Macavity is called a mystery cat because he is a master criminal who commits crimes smoothly but never gets caught. He vanishes from the crime scene before the police can arrive.

Q2. What does the poet mean when he calls Macavity the "Hidden Paw"?

Ans: The phrase "Hidden Paw" means that Macavity is the master brain behind all the crimes, but he hides his paws (clues) so well that his direct involvement can never be legally proven.

Q3. Why is Macavity described as the despair of Scotland Yard?

Ans: He is the despair of Scotland Yard (the London Police headquarters) because whenever they reach the scene of a crime to catch him, Macavity is simply not there.

Q4. How does Macavity break the "law of gravity" according to the poet?

Ans: The poet humorously states that Macavity breaks the law of gravity through his supernatural levitation or floating in the air, which makes even a holy fakir stare at him in wonder.

Q5. How does the poet describe the physical appearance of Macavity?

Ans: Macavity is a tall, thin ginger cat with deeply sunken eyes. His brow is deeply lined with thought, his head is highly domed, and his coat is dusty from neglect.

Q6. What does Macavity do with his head while moving?

Ans: While moving, Macavity sways his head from side to side with smooth movements like a snake, making people think he is half-asleep when he is actually wide awake.



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Q7. What are the common crimes committed by Macavity mentioned in the poem?

Ans: His common crimes include looting the larder (pantry), stealing milk, breaking greenhouse glasses, stifling Peke dogs, and misplacing important government treaty papers.

Q8. Why does the poet call Macavity a "fiend in feline shape" and a "monster of depravity"?

Ans: The poet uses these strong terms because beneath his innocent cat appearance, Macavity behaves like an evil devil (fiend) who completely lacks moral values or goodness.

Q9. Why is Macavity called the "Napoleon of Crime"?

Ans: He is compared to Napoleon Bonaparte because just like the historical leader was a master strategist in wars, Macavity is the ultimate organizer and mastermind of all feline crimes.

Q10. Where can you find Macavity, and where can you definitely NOT find him?

Ans: You may find Macavity in a by-street or see him in a square, but whenever a crime is discovered, you can definitely not find him at the spot of the crime.

Q11. What is Macavity's alibi during a crime investigation?

Ans: Macavity always maintains a flawless alibi. His files show that he was always miles away, doing simple things like relaxing, licking his thumbs, or doing complex long division sums.

Q12. What is the central message or tone of this poem?

Ans: The central tone is highly humorous, mock-heroic, and entertaining. Eliot uses grand, dramatic language meant for human criminals to describe the mischievous antics of an ordinary house cat.

35 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

- 'Macavity: The Mystery Cat' is a delightfully humorous poem composed by: (A) Walt Whitman (B) T.S. Eliot (C) John Keats (D) Rupert Brooke
- T.S. Eliot was awarded the Nobel Prize for Literature in the year: (A) 1930 (B) 1945 (C) 1948 (D) 1954
- T.S. Eliot was a distinguished 20th-century poet, critic, and: (A) Scientist (B) Dramatist (C) Doctor (D) Politician
- Macavity is popularly known and designated by the poet as the: (A) Master Paw (B) Hidden Paw (C) Open Paw (D) Iron Paw
- Macavity is described as the absolute bafflement and despair of: (A) Delhi Police (B) Scotland Yard (C) FBI (D) Royal Navy
- When the Flying Squad reaches the scene of the crime,: (A) Macavity is sleeping (B) Macavity is not there (C) Macavity is fighting (D) Macavity is eating
- Macavity breaks human laws as well as the scientific law of: (A) motion (B) gravity (C) relativity (D) friction



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8. Macavity's powers of levitation would make a _____ stare in total wonder.: (A) doctor (B) fakir / magician (C) king (D) teacher
9. Physically, Macavity is described by the poet as a _____ cat.: (A) fat and black (B) ginger (C) small and white (D) brown
10. Macavity is very tall and thin, and his eyes are deeply: (A) bright (B) sunken (C) large (D) blue
11. His brow is deeply lined with thought, and his head is highly: (A) flat (B) domed (C) square (D) small
12. Macavity's coat is dusty from neglect, and his whiskers are: (A) polished (B) uncombed (C) cut (D) red
13. Macavity sways his head from side to side with movements like a: (A) dog (B) snake (C) monkey (D) lion
14. When you think Macavity is half-asleep, he is always: (A) daydreaming (B) wide awake (C) dead (D) crying
15. "For he's a _____ in feline shape, a monster of depravity.": (A) angel (B) fiend / devil (C) friend (D) servant
16. The poet calls Macavity a "monster of _____ .": (A) kindness (B) depravity / wickedness (C) intelligence (D) dynamic
17. You may meet Macavity in a by-street or in a: (A) palace (B) square (C) school (D) hospital
18. When a crime is discovered, then Macavity is: (A) captured (B) not there (C) eating (D) running away visibly
19. Macavity is described as the ultimate mastermind, famously called the _____ of Crime.: (A) King (B) Napoleon (C) Alexander (D) Dictator
20. Macavity often loots the larder and steals the: (A) clothes (B) milk (C) money (D) books
21. He is known for stifling a small dog belonging to the _____ breed.: (A) Labrador (B) Peke (C) German Shepherd (D) Bulldog
22. When the Foreign Office finds a Treaty gone astray, it is suspected to be the work of: (A) Macavity (B) Mungojerrie (C) Griddlebone (D) Old Deuteronomy
23. Macavity's footprints or claws are never found in any file of: (A) the school (B) Scotland Yard / police (C) the bank (D) the court
24. While a crime is reported, Macavity is usually resting or licking his: (A) fur (B) thumbs (C) ears (D) tail
25. Macavity also pretends to engage his mind in doing complicated accounts of long: (A) addition (B) division (C) multiplication (D) fraction
26. Other agent cats mentioned in the poem who act as his operations assistants are Griddlebone and: (A) Squeezer (B) Mungojerrie (C) Guess (D) Benjy
27. Macavity merely controls the operations and acts as the director of the feline: (A) army (B) underworld / crime circle (C) school (D) business



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28. The poem 'Macavity: The Mystery Cat' is collected from Eliot's famous children's book: (A) The Waste Land (B) Old Possum's Book of Practical Cats (C) Four Quartets (D) Murder in the Cathedral
29. The tone of the poem can be best described as mock-heroic, playful, and: (A) tragic (B) satirical / humorous (C) highly serious (D) historical
30. The word 'alibi' used in the text represents a formal plea of being: (A) guilty (B) somewhere else during a crime (C) sick (D) caught
31. The word 'feline' directly relates to or belongs to the family of: (A) dogs (B) cats (C) birds (D) reptiles
32. Macavity is completely devoid of any sense of human: (A) hunger (B) morality / honor (C) speed (D) fashion
33. The rhyme scheme of most of the stanzas in this narrative poem is: (A) ABAB (B) AABB (C) ABBA (D) ABCD
34. T.S. Eliot was born in the USA but later acquired the citizenship of: (A) France (B) United Kingdom / Britain (C) Germany (D) India
35. The poem highlights that beneath a quiet, innocent look, there can exist a highly _____ mind.: (A) honest (B) deceptive / criminal (C) holy (D) lazy

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